I never expected to be diagnosed with thyroid cancer.

But after I was, it was encouraging to know that it's usually treatable. However, this depends on early detection and proper treatment. It's crucial to learn as much about thyroid cancer as you can, to know what questions to ask, and to understand what treatments are available. I'm living proof that early detection and treatment really work.

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That's why, if you are associated in any way with thyroid cancer, my best advice is to learn as much about it as you can and to utilize the services of ThyCa: Thyroid Cancer Survivors' Association.

ThyCa is a tremendous resource for people who are either newly diagnosed or are living with thyroid cancer. ThyCa is also a valuable information source for physicians who are treating thyroid cancer patients.

Thyroid cancer is something you need to take charge of - and that's just what I did!

All the best,
Catherine

"ThyCa is a tremendous resource for people with thyroid cancer"

About Catherine Bell

Catherine Bell was born in London and moved to Los Angeles with her family when she was three years old. She attended the University of California, Los Angeles. Catherine was diagnosed with thyroid cancer at age twenty-one.

During J.A.G.'s first season, she made a brief appearance. She became the female lead in the second season. Catherine has also appeared in many other television programs and the feature film *Bruce Almighty* with Jim Carrey, Jennifer Anniston and Morgan Freeman.

Staying healthy is Catherine's first priority. She eats well, exercises, and enjoys riding motorcycles, biking, kick-boxing and painting. Catherine lives in Los Angeles with her husband and daughter.

How ThyCa Can Help

ThyCa: Thyroid Cancer Survivors' Association is a nationwide network of thyroid cancer survivors, family, and friends. ThyCa's mission is:

To Educate, so that patients and families better understand the disease.

To Participate, so that others learn from the experience.

To Communicate, so that thyroid cancer survivors and health care professionals can better understand each other's needs.

To Support Research, for a future free of thyroid cancer.

ThyCa support services and resources:

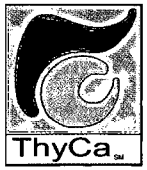
- Award-winning educational web site: www.thyca.org
- Local and e-mail support groups
- One-to-one communication
- Free newsletter and other publications
- Regional workshops and annual conferences

ThyCa is guided by a Medical Advisory Counsel of thyroid cancer experts. ThyCa welcomes patients and caregivers in all stages of thyroid cancer testing, treatment, and monitoring. Through various support groups and events, ThyCa offers people with thyroid cancer and medical professionals the opportunity to interact, gather information and share their experiences.

Things you should know about thyroid cancer

- Signs to discuss with your physician include: a lump in your neck, lymph node swelling, fullness in the neck, voice changes, difficulty breathing or swallowing, or pain in the throat or neck.
- Thyroid cancer affects three times as many women as men and occurs in all age groups.
- Thyroid cancer is one of the few cancers that is increasing in the number of new cases diagnosed each year.
- There are several types of thyroid cancer: papillary, follicular, medullary, anaplastic, and variants.
- Treatment depends on the type of thyroid cancer, tumor size, age of the patient, and other factors.
- Treatment may include one or more of the following: surgery, thyroid hormone replacement, radioactive iodine, external beam radiation, and chemotherapy.
- Thyroid cancer can sometimes reappear decades after initial treatment. Because of this, patients should have follow-up tests throughout their lifetime, so that any recurrence can be treated properly.
- Important new treatment options for thyroid cancer are currently being researched.

For thyroid cancer information and resources, visit ThyCa online at www.thyca.org



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ThyCa is a nonprofit 501(c)(3) organization.

Cover photograph - Paramount Television
Copy and Design provided by Levelhead - levelheadcreative.com
Printing provided by Millennium Graphics - Norwood, MA

One of the many faces of

Thyroid Cancer

CATHERINE BELL

Actress, co-star of the hit TV series J.A.G., thyroid cancer survivor

Useful information for people with thyroid cancer and their caregivers, from

THYCA: THYROID CANCER SURVIVORS' ASSOCIATION

www.thyca.org